



English — Grammar + Literature Practice
— 20 Marks (English) [Generic, Grades All]

ANSWER KEY — FOR GRADING

Subject: English | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 20 | Time Allowed: 0h 25m | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A carries 1 mark each; Section B carries 1 mark each.
3. Answer Section B questions in 10-20 words each.
4. Answer Section C questions in 30-40 words each.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A — Grammar Attempt all 8 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
1	The mountain is too steep for the climbers to ascend. [Sentence Transformation] (A) The mountain is so steep that the climbers cannot ascended it. (B) The mountain is so steep that the climbers could not ascend. (C) The mountain is so steep that the climbers do not ascend it. (D) The mountain is so steep that the climbers cannot ascend it. Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? The 'too...to' construction is replaced by 'so...that + subject + cannot/could not + verb'. The present tense 'is' in the original requires 'cannot' (not 'could not'), and the object pronoun 'it' must replace 'the mountain' in the that-clause. 'The mountain is so steep that the climbers cannot ascend it' is correct. The option with 'cannot ascended' uses an incorrect verb form after the modal. The option with 'could not ascend' drops the needed object 'it' and mismatches the tense. The option with 'do not ascend' changes the meaning from inability to choice.	1
2	The company scarcely advertises its eco-friendly products on television, ____ [Question Tags] (A) doesn't it (B) hasn't it (C) isn't it (D) does it Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? The adverb 'scarcely' makes the statement negative even though 'not' is absent, so the tag must be positive. The main verb 'advertises' has no auxiliary, so the tag uses 'does': 'does it'. 'Doesn't it' wrongly treats the statement as positive, 'hasn't it' uses the wrong auxiliary, and 'isn't it' uses a 'be' auxiliary that is not present.	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
3	The child talked as if he ___ a ghost. [Clauses] (A) had seen (B) sees (C) has seen (D) was seeing Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? After 'as if' describing an unreal or imaginary situation in the past, the subjunctive past perfect is required. Since 'talked' is past tense and seeing a ghost is imaginary, 'had seen' correctly marks the unreal past. Present-tense forms like 'sees' and 'has seen' do not match the past frame, and 'was seeing' does not convey the unreal meaning required by 'as if'.	1
4	The herbal tea ___ remarkably sweet despite being brewed with ordinary garden leaves. [Verbs (Action Words)] (A) tasted sweetly (B) was tasting sweetly (C) tasted sweet (D) had tasted sweetly Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? Here 'tasted' functions as a linking verb connecting the subject 'tea' to the adjective 'sweet,' which describes the tea. Linking verbs require an adjective complement, not an adverb, so 'sweetly' is incorrect in all three distractors. The simple past 'tasted' with the adjective 'sweet' is the correct combination.	1
5	Did the principal announce the results? [Sentence Transformation] (A) Was the results announced by the principal? (B) Have the results been announced by the principal? (C) Were the results announced by the principal? (D) Were the results being announced by the principal? Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? An interrogative active sentence in the simple past ('Did...announce') becomes a passive interrogative with 'were/was + past participle'. The object 'the results' becomes the subject, requiring the plural auxiliary 'were'. The correct form is 'Were the results announced by the principal?' 'Was the results' has subject-verb disagreement, 'Have...been announced' shifts to present perfect, and 'were being announced' shifts to past continuous.	1
6	The number of people displaced by the devastating flood ___ estimated to be in the thousands. [Subject-Verb Concord] (A) are (B) were (C) have been (D) is Answer: Correct Option: (D)	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The phrase 'the number of' refers to a specific quantity and takes a singular verb because 'number' is the subject. 'Is' is correct. 'Are', 'were', and 'have been' are plural forms that would be appropriate with 'a number of' (meaning 'several'), not with 'the number of'.	
7	Traditional farming methods are labour-intensive, ___ modern techniques rely heavily on technology and machinery. [Conjunctions] (A) whereas (B) so (C) because (D) if Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? The sentence contrasts two different approaches to farming. 'Whereas' is the adversative conjunction that introduces a contrasting statement between two independent clauses. 'So' would indicate a result, 'because' would indicate a cause, and 'if' would introduce a condition — none expresses the comparative contrast needed here.	1
8	In the sentence "The novel [Phrases] (A) assigned for holiday homework (B) The novel assigned for holiday homework (C) interesting and informative (D) quite interesting and informative Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? An adjective phrase is headed by an adjective and may include intensifiers and complements. 'quite interesting and informative' is the complete adjective phrase — 'quite' is the intensifier modifying the coordinate adjectives 'interesting and informative'. Option A is a participial phrase, option B is a noun phrase, and option C omits the intensifier 'quite' that is part of the phrase.	1
Section B — Literature (Very Short Answer) Attempt all 6 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
9	Why does the author state that reaching a world-class standard in any field requires at least ten years? Answer: The author states this because achieving greatness requires singular and intensive pursuit of the subject. It demands significant effort and sacrifice to realise one's dream and reach a world-class level. ► Why? This question tests the comprehension of the relationship between time, effort, and achieving world-class standards as mentioned in the letter. [Ch 15: Follow That Dream]	1
10	Read the highlighted words in the following phrases from the story. Now, revisit the story and underline the prepositions. Answer: across, over, under, behind	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The highlighted words in the provided phrases—across, over, under, and behind—are prepositions. As defined in the context, prepositions are words that show the relationship of a noun or pronoun to other words in a sentence, often indicating direction or location. ► Step-by-step: - Step 1: Identify the highlighted words in the given phrases: across, over, under, behind. - Step 2: Recall the definition provided in the context: prepositions show the relationship of a noun or pronoun to other words, indicating direction, location, time, or manner. - Step 3: Confirm that the highlighted words fit this definition and thus are the prepositions to be underlined. [Ch 7: Vitamin-M]	
11	What realization did Johnsy come to after observing the last leaf clinging to the creeper? Answer: Johnsy realized that it is a sin to want to die. She acknowledged being depressed and gloomy and recognized how lovingly Sue had cared for her. ► Why? This tests understanding of character development and the thematic shift in Johnsy's attitude from despair to hope. [Ch 5: Winds of Change]	1
12	How did Leela help resolve the conflict between Nabin and Shruti? Answer: Leela opened Nabin's eyes by reminding him of his own past. She revealed that Nabin himself had gone against his family's wishes to play the violin, which made him realise his fears about Shruti were baseless. ► Why? Nabin admits in Act III that Leela opened his eyes by reminding him of his own rebellion against family tradition, leading to his change of heart. [Ch 11: Twin Melodies]	1
13	What is an allusion, and what does the reference to 'Buddha's dhamma' allude to? Answer: An allusion is an indirect reference to a well-known person, place, event, or cultural element. The reference to 'Buddha's dhamma' alludes to Gautama Buddha's teachings of compassion, non-violence, and enlightenment. ► Why? This question combines the definition of a literary device with its specific application in the poem, testing both conceptual knowledge and contextual understanding. [Ch 2: Bharat Our Land]	1
14	When designing a poster to announce an event, one must ensure it is visually attractive, uses letters of different fonts and sizes, and adheres to a word limit of _____ words. Answer: 50 ► Why? The writing task section specifies the features of a poster, including a strict word limit of 50 words. [Ch 4: Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations]	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section C — Literature (Short Answer) Attempt all 3 questions. Each carries 2 mark(s).		
15	Symbolism — Each vocation in the poem symbolises something more than just a job. What does it symbolise? Answer: Each vocation in the poem symbolises the very identity of the individuals practicing it. The poem emphasises this by stating, "The voice of their vocation is the voice of their identity." This means that a person's work is not just a means of earning, but a reflection of who they are and their place in society. Additionally, these vocations symbolise the vibrancy and richness of cultural traditions and skills. Through their everyday work, the artisans and craftspersons keep the cultural heritage alive, making their vocations a celebration of their unique skills and contributions to the nation. ► <i>Why?</i> The context directly provides the answer through the line, 'The voice of their vocation is the voice of their identity,' indicating that a vocation symbolises a person's identity. Furthermore, the context mentions that the poem captures a mood reflecting the 'vibrancy and richness of cultural traditions and skills,' showing that vocations also symbolise the preservation of culture and heritage. [Ch 4: Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations]	2
16	The poet uses imagery (descriptive language to create vivid mental pictures that appeal to the senses). Give any two examples from the poem. Answer: The poet uses imagery to create vivid mental pictures that appeal to the senses. The first example is "sunny golden land", which creates a bright, radiant visual picture of the country, appealing to the sense of sight and suggesting its richness and glory. A second example is the depiction of the Ganga, which is described as generous and graceful. This creates a vivid visual image of the flowing river, appealing to the senses and symbolising purity and generosity. ► <i>Why?</i> The question asks for two examples of imagery (descriptive language appealing to the senses). Based on the context, 'sunny golden land' is a visual description suggesting richness and glory. The 'Ganga' is depicted as generous and graceful, creating a visual image of the river's purity. The 'Himavant' described as mighty and unparalleled is also a valid example of visual imagery suggesting strength. [Ch 2: Bharat Our Land]	2
17	What is your favourite experience with them? Answer: My favourite experience with my grandmother is spending time with her on the open terrace of our house on a summer night under a full moon. After dinner, Avva came and sat next to me while we were sleeping outside. Her affectionate hands touched my forehead, making me feel deeply cared for. It was during this quiet and peaceful moment that I realised she wanted to speak to me about something important. This intimate and loving interaction makes it my most cherished experience with her.	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The question is a personal reflection prompt from the textbook. Since the answer must rely solely on the provided context, the response is framed using the narrator's experience with their grandmother (Avva). The text highlights the touching moment on the terrace where Avva affectionately touches the narrator's forehead, which serves as the best example of a favourite experience with an elderly relative from the passage. [Ch 1: How I Taught My Grandmother to Read]	

